

in a 240GB capacity performing at 500MB/s sequential read and 450MB/s sequential write.

Rob Crooke, VP and GM, Non-Volatile Memory (NVM) Solutions Group, Intel, said, "The Intel SSD 335 uses Hi-K/metal gate planar cell technology, which overcomes NAND process scaling constraints to deliver the smallest-area NAND cell and die in the industry. By pushing technology constraints and using process innovation, Intel can continue to progress SSD technology and pass along savings to our customers."

Windows 8 launched in India

Microsoft recently announced the availability of Windows 8 in India and around the world. Windows 8 offers a new user interface and a wide range of apps with the opening of Windows Store.

Windows 8 PCs and tablets will be available in India from 14 OEM partners—Acer, Asus, Dell, Fujitsu, HCL, Hewlett Packard, Lenovo, RP Infosystems, Sai Info System, Samsung, Sony, Toshiba, Wipro and Zenith Computers—on a variety of form factors.

In India, over 250 Windows 8 enabled devices, including 23 completely new SKUs of Windows 8 PCs, are available across a hundred cities and more than 2500 retail stores.

Consumers can also upgrade their existing PCs to the new version. Consumers of Windows XP, Windows Vista or Windows 7 PCs purchased between June 2, 2012 and January 31, 2013 are qualified to download Windows 8 Pro for an estimated retail price of Rs 1999.

Linux Lite 1.0.0, a beginner-friendly distro

While Windows 8 is grabbing the headlines, here comes Linux Lite 1.0.0—an Open Source distro for beginners. The official announcement about the availability of this distro was made by Jerry Bezencon.

The post said, "Linux Lite is free for everyone to use and share, and suitable for people who are new to Linux or for people who want a lightweight environ-



Intel's first 20nm SSD memory (Intel SSD DC S3700 Handshake)

ment that is also fully functional."

Giving more details about the distro, Bezencon informed, "You get a Web browser, e-mail, music and movie player, CD/DVD burner, office software, voice chat, photo editor, network access tools, printing and the Linux Lite help manual. All the tools you need out of the box to get you up and running straight away and using Linux Lite productively as soon as you have installed it."

Linux Lite is based on Ubuntu 12.04 LTS. Software included are GParted, LibreOffice Writer, LibreOffice Calc, XFBurn CD/DVD Bumer, VLC Media Player, Firefox Web Browser with Flash, OpenJDK Java v6, Mumble Voice Chat, Thunderbird Email, XChat IRC Client, Gimp Image Editor, Leafpad Text Editor and Xarchiver.

MK803 PC-on-a-stick runs ICS

Raspberry Pi surely seems to be an inspiration for many. After a host of alternatives of the small-sized PC, a PC-on-a-stick from a company called Miniland has entered the market.

MK803 is an Android-based PC that comes in the form of a dongle. It looks like a fat flash drive, which comes equipped with an Amlogic

AML8726-M3 processor operating at 1.5 GHz. It is based on an ARM Cortex-A9 design and is expected to perform better than its predecessor MK802.

The PC-on-a-stick runs Android 4.0 aka Ice Cream Sandwich out-of-the-box but the company says that it will support Linux operating system soon.

Solar auto-rickshaw

Students at PSNA College of Engineering and Technology, Dindigul, have designed a hybrid auto rickshaw powered by solar and wind energy, with additional support of petrol, which is used only to recharge the battery of the vehicle. Plug-in charging facility is also available.

The auto-rickshaw can run for about 80 km continuously on full charge carrying four passengers. With solar energy and wind energy, it can travel up to 96 km. Interestingly, it cuts fuel emission by 90 per cent.

The project has been developed under the guidance of assistant professor J.E. Moshe Dayan, who informs that this hybrid auto has an internal combustion engine, switched reluctance motor, wind turbine, photovoltaic system and an energy storage system.

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